

Word family: TONE / TONES / TONED / TONING / TONAL / TONALLY / TONALITY / TONELESS / TONER

Base word: tone

Plural: tones

Past tense: toned

Past participle: toned

** -ing form:** toning

Related forms: tonal, tonally, tonality, toneless, toned, toner

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Major useful extensions

tone of voice, speak in a calm/angry tone, take a certain tone, watch your tone, change one's tone, tone of a sentence, tone of an email, formal/informal tone, literary tone, tone of a discussion, set the tone, strike a tone, lower the tone, tone-deaf, musical tone, tone quality, whole tone, semitone, pure tone, test tone, tone control, dial tone, busy tone, warning tone, touch-tone, ringtone, lexical tone, tone language, tone mark, tone contour, tone sandhi, colour tone, warm/cool tone, skin tone, undertone, two-tone, tone-on-tone, tonal range, midtone, halftone, muscle tone, toned muscles, tone the body, tone up, tone down, toner, hair toner, skin toner, printer toner, monotone, undertone, overtone, tonality.

A. PASSAGE SENSE — HOW THE VOICE EXPRESSES ATTITUDE

1. tone = manner or quality of the voice showing emotion, attitude, intention, etc. — 語氣 ; 口吻 ; 聲調

Passage anchor

> “...students who seldom spoke in class could identify the conflict, describe the characters' motives and explain how **tone**, gesture and hesitation changed the meaning of a sentence.”

Meaning

Here, **tone** means:

the way a person says something, especially the emotional or attitudinal quality carried by the voice

語氣 ; 口吻 ; 說話時表達態度或情緒的聲音方式

The actual words can stay the same while a different tone makes them sound:

* sincere

- * sarcastic
- * angry
- * frightened
- * doubtful
- * kind
- * impatient
- * threatening

Practice 1

Her **tone** made the question sound like an accusation.

她的**語氣**令那個問題聽起來像是在指責別人。

Practice 2

The same sentence can have a different meaning depending on the speaker's **tone**.

同一句話可以因說話者的**語氣**不同而產生不同意思。

B. TONE OF VOICE

2. tone of voice

= particular way someone's voice sounds, especially as an expression of attitude or emotion
語氣；口吻；說話語調

Practice

1. His **tone of voice** sounded impatient.

他的**語氣**聽起來很不耐煩。

2. Try using a gentler **tone of voice**.

嘗試使用較溫和的**語氣**。

Very high-value expression.

C. SPEAK IN A ... TONE

3. speak in a calm / angry / cold / friendly tone

= speak with a particular emotional quality

****以.....的語氣說話****

Practice

1. She spoke ****in a calm tone****.

她以****冷靜的語氣****說話。

2. "Leave me alone," he said ****in a sharp tone****.

「別煩我。」他用****尖銳的語氣****說。

D. TAKE / USE A TONE

4. take a particular tone

= adopt a particular manner of speaking or writing

****採取某種口吻 / 語氣****

Practice

1. His reply ****took a more serious tone****.

他的回答轉為****較嚴肅的口吻****。

2. The conversation suddenly ****took an angry tone****.

對話突然變成了****憤怒的語氣****。

5. use a ... tone

= communicate using a particular manner

****使用.....語氣****

Practice

1. Avoid using an accusing ****tone****.

避免使用帶有指責意味的****語氣****。

E. WATCH / MIND YOUR TONE

6. watch your tone

= be careful about the manner in which you are speaking, especially because it sounds disrespectful

****注意你的語氣；說話客氣一點****

Practice

1. ****Watch your tone**** when you speak to your teacher.

跟老師說話時要****注意你的語氣****。

Often a warning.

7. mind your tone

Especially BrE:

= watch your tone

****注意說話口吻****

F. DON'T TAKE THAT TONE WITH ME

8. take that tone with someone

= speak to someone in an objectionable, disrespectful, arrogant, etc. manner

****用那種口氣跟某人說話****

Practice

1. Don't ****take that tone with me****.

別****用那種口氣跟我說話****。

Very common confrontational expression.

G. CHANGE ONE'S TONE

9. change one's tone

A. literally change the manner of speaking

****改變語氣****

B. figuratively change one's attitude or position

****改變態度 / 口風****

Practice

1. His ****tone changed**** when he realized the mistake.

他發現錯誤後，****語氣變了****。

2. Critics ****changed their tone**** after the results improved.

成果改善後，批評者的****態度 / 口風也改變了****。

H. TONE = ATTITUDE EXPRESSED THROUGH LANGUAGE

10. tone = attitude conveyed by words, not necessarily audible voice — 語氣；態度；口吻

Practice

1. I disliked the ****tone**** of the message.

我不喜歡那則訊息的****語氣****。

2. Her email had a professional ****tone****.

她的電郵採用了專業的****口吻****。

This extends the passage sense from spoken voice into written communication.

I. TONE OF AN EMAIL / MESSAGE / LETTER

11. tone of writing

= emotional/social attitude communicated by written language

****文字語氣；行文口吻****

Practice

1. Check the ****tone of your email**** before sending it.

發送前先檢查電郵的****語氣****。

2. The letter's ****tone**** was unnecessarily aggressive.

那封信的****口吻****過分強硬。

J. FORMAL / INFORMAL TONE

12. formal tone

= serious, professional, socially formal style of expression

****正式語氣 / 正式文風****

13. informal tone

= relaxed, conversational manner

****非正式語氣；輕鬆口吻****

Practice

1. A job application usually requires a more ****formal tone****.

求職申請通常需要較****正式的語氣****。

K. FRIENDLY / POLITE / PROFESSIONAL TONE

14. friendly tone

****友善口吻****

15. polite tone

****有禮語氣****

16. professional tone

****專業口吻****

These are highly productive collocations rather than separate dictionary senses.

L. SARCASTIC / IRONIC TONE

17. sarcastic tone

= manner suggesting mockery or contempt by saying something not meant literally

****諷刺語氣****

Practice

1. I could hear the ****sarcastic tone**** in his reply.

我聽得出他回答中的****諷刺語氣****。

18. ironic tone

= tone conveying irony

****反諷語氣****

M. TONE IN LITERATURE

19. literary tone

= writer's or narrator's attitude toward the subject, characters, or audience

****作品語調；作者 / 敘述者的態度****

Practice

1. The passage has a humorous ****tone****.

這段文字帶有幽默的****語調****。

2. The author adopts a critical ****tone****.

作者採取批判性的****口吻****。

Major literature-analysis sense.

N. TONE OF A STORY / PASSAGE

20. tone of a text

= emotional or attitudinal character communicated by a text

****文章的語調 / 態度****

Common descriptions include:

- * serious
- * humorous
- * sympathetic
- * critical
- * optimistic
- * pessimistic
- * bitter
- * nostalgic
- * respectful
- * mocking

O. TONE vs MOOD — LITERARY DISTINCTION

21. tone

= attitude conveyed by the writer/speaker

****作者 / 說話者的態度****

22. mood

= emotional atmosphere experienced by the reader/audience

****氣氛 ; 讀者感受到的情緒****

Compare:

> The writer's ****tone**** is sarcastic.

> 作者的****語調****帶有諷刺意味。

> The scene creates a tense ****mood****.

> 場景營造緊張的****氣氛****。

This distinction is very important in literary analysis.

P. GENERAL CHARACTER / ATMOSPHERE OF A SITUATION

23. tone = general character, mood, or level of seriousness of an event, discussion, relationship, etc. — 基調；氣氛；整體格調

Practice

1. The opening remarks established a serious **tone**.

開場發言定下了嚴肅的**基調**。

2. One rude comment changed the **tone of the meeting**.

一句無禮的話改變了會議的**氣氛 / 基調**。

This extends beyond a single person's voice.

Q. SET THE TONE

24. set the tone

= establish the mood, style, expectations, or character for what follows

定下基調；奠定氣氛

Practice

1. The teacher's opening question **set the tone for the lesson**.

老師的開場問題為整堂課**定下基調**。

2. Her friendliness **set the tone for the meeting**.

她的友善態度為會議**營造了基調**。

Very high-value idiom.

25. set the tone for something

= establish how something is likely to proceed

****為.....定下基調****

R. STRIKE A ... TONE

26. strike a tone

= deliberately adopt a particular manner or attitude

****採取某種語調 / 立場****

Practice

1. The statement ****struck a conciliatory tone****.

聲明採取了****和解的口吻****。

2. She tried to ****strike a positive tone****.

她嘗試採取****正面的基調****。

Common in formal/news writing.

S. THE RIGHT / WRONG TONE

27. strike the right tone

= communicate in a manner appropriate to the situation

****拿捏合適的語氣****

Practice

1. The speech ****struck the right tone****.

演說的****語氣拿捏得恰到好處****。

28. strike the wrong tone

= use an inappropriate manner

****語氣 / 基調不合適****

T. LOWER THE TONE

29. lower the tone

Especially BrE:

= make a conversation, event, place, etc. less respectable, refined, or serious

****降低格調；使氣氛變俗****

Practice

1. His crude jokes ****lowered the tone**** of the evening.

他的粗俗笑話****降低了整晚的格調****。

Distinct idiomatic extension.

U. TONE AT THE TOP

30. tone at the top

Business/compliance:

= ethical culture and standards communicated by senior leadership

****高層定調；管理層建立的道德 / 合規文化****

Practice

1. Strong compliance begins with the right ****tone at the top****.

良好的合規文化始於管理高層所建立的正確****基調****。

Established business/governance expression.

V. TONE POLICING

31. tone policing

Discourse/social term:

= focusing on the emotional manner in which someone expresses a concern instead of addressing the substance of the concern

****語氣規訓；以語氣問題轉移對實質內容的討論****

Example

Critics described the response as ****tone policing**** because it focused on how angrily people spoke rather than what they were complaining about.

批評者把這種回應形容為****語氣規訓****，因為重點放在別人說話是否憤怒，而不是其投訴內容本身。

Modern but somewhat specialized.

W. MUSICAL TONE — A SOUND / NOTE

**** 32. tone = musical sound of a particular pitch — 音；音調；樂音**

Practice

1. The instrument produced a clear ****tone****.

樂器發出清晰的****樂音****。

2. She played a single ****tone****.

她奏出一個****音****。

Major distinct sense.

X. HIGH / LOW TONE

**** 33. high tone / low tone**

= sound at a high or low pitch

****高音 / 低音****

Practice

1. The alarm emits a high ****tone****.

警報器發出一個****高音調****。

Y. PURE TONE

34. pure tone

Acoustics:

= sound consisting essentially of a single frequency

****純音****

Practice

1. Hearing tests may use ****pure tones****.

聽力測試可能使用****純音****。

Established acoustics/audiology term.

Z. TEST TONE

35. test tone

= standardized sound used to test audio equipment, hearing, broadcasting, etc.

****測試音****

Practice

1. The speaker played a ****test tone****.

揚聲器播放了一個****測試音****。

AA. TONE QUALITY / TIMBRE

36. tone = distinctive quality of a musical instrument or singing voice — 音色

Practice

1. The violin has a warm ****tone****.

這把小提琴有溫暖的****音色****。

2. Her voice has a rich ****tone****.

她的聲音有豐富的****音色****。

Here, ****tone**** does not mean pitch.

37. tone quality

= characteristic sound quality

****音質；音色****

38. tone colour / tone color

= timbre; characteristic quality distinguishing sounds of similar pitch

****音色****

Music term.

AB. MUSICAL INTERVAL — WHOLE TONE

39. tone = interval of two semitones

Especially BrE music terminology:

****全音****

Example

C to D is a ****tone****.

C 到 D 相隔一個****全音****。

In AmE, ****whole step**** is common.

40. semitone

= half of a whole tone

****半音****

AmE equivalent:

****half step****

AC. WHOLE-TONE SCALE

41. whole-tone scale

= musical scale composed entirely of whole-tone intervals

****全音音階****

Established specialist music term.

AD. TONAL

42. tonal — relating to musical tones or tonality — 音調的；調性的

Practice

1. The piece has an unusual ****tonal structure****.

這首作品有不尋常的****調性結構****。

AE. TONALITY — MUSIC

43. tonality

= organization of music around a central key or tonal center

****調性****

Practice

1. The composer experiments with ****tonality****.

作曲家對****調性****作出實驗。

Established music-theory noun.

AF. TONAL CENTER

44. tonal center

= central pitch/key around which music is organized

****調性中心 ; 主音中心****

Specialist music term.

AG. TWELVE-TONE MUSIC

45. twelve-tone music / twelve-tone technique

= twentieth-century compositional system organizing all twelve chromatic notes in a structured series

****十二音音樂 / 十二音技法****

Established music term.

46. tone row

= ordered series of pitches used in twelve-tone composition

****音列****

Specialist.

AH. TONE POEM

47. tone poem

= orchestral composition intended to evoke a story, image, idea, etc.; symphonic poem

****交響詩****

Established music term.

AI. TONE-DEAF — LITERAL

48. tone-deaf

= unable or poor at recognizing and reproducing differences in musical pitch

****音準辨別能力差的；五音不全的****

Practice

1. He says he is completely ****tone-deaf****.

他說自己完全****五音不全****。

AJ. TONE-DEAF — FIGURATIVE

49. tone-deaf

Figurative:

= insensitive to the feelings, circumstances, or public mood surrounding a situation

****對情境 / 他人感受麻木的；不合時宜的****

Practice

1. The joke seemed ****tone-deaf**** given the circumstances.

考慮到當時情況，那個笑話顯得非常****不合時宜****。

2. The campaign was criticized as ****tone-deaf****.

那項宣傳被批評為****完全沒有顧及大眾感受****。

Very high-value modern figurative meaning.

AK. TONELESS

50. toneless — lacking expressive variation in the voice — 毫無感情 / 起伏的

Practice

1. He replied in a ****toneless voice****.

他用****毫無感情的聲音****回答。

Can also mean lacking musical tone/quality, but the voice sense is most useful.

AL. MONOTONE

51. monotone

= unchanging pitch or manner of speaking

****單調的聲調；毫無抑揚的聲音****

Practice

1. He read the paragraph ****in a monotone****.

他用****毫無抑揚的單調聲音****讀那段文字。

AM. LINGUISTIC TONE — WORD MEANING DISTINGUISHED BY PITCH

52. tone = pitch pattern that distinguishes word meaning in a tonal language — 聲調

Meaning

In languages such as Mandarin or Cantonese, different pitch patterns can distinguish lexical meaning.

Practice

1. The word has a different meaning when pronounced with a different ****tone****.

這個詞使用不同****聲調****時，意思會不同。

2. Learners need to practise the ****tones**** carefully.

學習者需要仔細練習****聲調****。

Major language-learning sense.

AN. TONE LANGUAGE / TONAL LANGUAGE

53. tone language / tonal language

= language in which pitch patterns can distinguish word meanings

****聲調語言****

Practice

1. Cantonese is a ****tonal language****.

粵語是一種****聲調語言****。

AO. TONE MARK

54. tone mark

= written symbol indicating tone

****聲調符號****

Practice

1. Add the correct ****tone mark****.

加上正確的****聲調符號****。

AP. TONE NUMBER

55. tone number

= number used in some transcription systems to indicate lexical tone

****聲調數字****

For example, language-learning materials may label tones numerically.

AQ. TONE CONTOUR

56. tone contour

Linguistics:

= pattern of pitch movement within a tone

****聲調輪廓；音高曲線****

Specialist but established.

AR. TONE SANDHI

57. tone sandhi

Linguistics:

= systematic change in the pronunciation of a tone because of neighboring tones or grammatical context

****連讀變調；聲調變化****

Established specialist term.

AS. SIGNAL TONE

58. tone = electronic sound used as a signal — 提示音；訊號音

Practice

1. Wait for the ****tone**** before speaking.

等到聽見****提示音****後再說話。

2. The machine emitted a warning ****tone****.

機器發出警告****提示音****。

Major modern sense.

AT. DIAL TONE

59. dial tone

= telephone sound indicating that the line is available for dialing

****撥號音****

Practice

1. I picked up the phone but heard no **dial tone**.

我拿起電話，但沒有聽到**撥號音**。

AU. BUSY TONE / ENGAGED TONE

60. busy tone

= telephone signal indicating the called line is busy

忙音

Especially common in AmE/general technical English.

61. engaged tone

Especially BrE:

= busy tone

忙音

AV. RING TONE / RINGTONE

62. ringtone

= sound played by a phone to indicate an incoming call

電話鈴聲

Practice

1. I changed my **ringtone**.

我更換了手機**鈴聲**。

Lexicalized compound.

AW. WARNING TONE

63. warning tone

= sound signaling danger or a problem

****警告音****

AX. NOTIFICATION TONE

64. notification tone

= sound alerting a user to a message/app notification

****通知提示音****

AY. TOUCH-TONE

65. touch-tone

= telephone signaling system in which keypad presses generate combinations of tones

****按鍵式音頻撥號的；雙音多頻的****

Example

a ****touch-tone phone****

****按鍵式電話****

Established telephony term.

AZ. TONE CONTROL — AUDIO

66. tone control

= control used to adjust bass, treble, or overall sound quality

****音調 / 音色控制****

Practice

1. Adjust the ****tone controls**** on the amplifier.

調校擴音器的****音調控制****。

BA. GUITAR / AMPLIFIER TONE

67. tone

Musician/audio usage:

= overall sonic character produced by an instrument, amplifier, effects, technique, etc.

****音色；聲音質感****

Practice

1. The guitarist spent hours adjusting his ****tone****.

吉他手花了幾小時調整自己的****音色****。

BB. TONEARM

68. tonearm / tone arm

= movable arm on a record player that carries the cartridge/stylus

****唱臂****

Established audio-equipment compound.

BC. COLOUR TONE

69. tone = particular shade, degree, or quality of a colour — 色調

Practice

1. The room uses warm earth ****tones****.

房間採用溫暖的大地****色調****。

2. Choose a softer ****tone of blue****.

選擇較柔和的藍****色調****。

Major visual-art/design sense.

BD. WARM / COOL TONES

70. warm tone

= colour character associated with reds, yellows, oranges, etc.

****暖色調****

71. cool tone

= colour character associated with blues, greens, etc.

****冷色調****

BE. LIGHT / DARK TONE

72. light tone / dark tone

= relatively light/dark visual value or colour

****淺色調 / 深色調****

BF. MUTED TONE

73. muted tone

= subdued, low-intensity colour

****柔和低調的色調****

Practice

1. The room is decorated in ****muted tones****.

房間以****柔和低調的色調****裝飾。

BG. SKIN TONE

74. skin tone

= natural colour or complexion of someone's skin

****膚色****

Practice

1. Choose a foundation that matches your **skin tone**.

選擇與你**膚色**相符的粉底。

Very high-value modern compound.

BH. UNDERTONE — COLOUR

75. undertone — colour

= subtle underlying colour beneath the obvious surface colour

底色；**底調**

Practice

1. Her skin has a warm **undertone**.

她的皮膚帶有暖色**底調**。

Common in beauty/fashion/design.

BI. UNDERTONE — HIDDEN FEELING

76. undertone — subtle underlying feeling or meaning

= feeling, attitude, or implication that is present but not directly expressed

隱約意味；**暗含的情緒 / 語氣**

Practice

1. There was an **undertone of anger** in his voice.

他的聲音中帶著一絲**隱約的怒意**。

2. The conversation had a threatening **undertone**.

對話中暗含一種**威脅意味**。

Major lexical extension.

BJ. UNDERTONE — QUIET VOICE

77. speak in an undertone

= speak quietly, often so that others cannot hear

****低聲說話****

Practice

1. They spoke ****in undertones****.

他們****低聲交談****。

BK. OVERTONE — SOUND

78. overtone

Acoustics/music:

= higher frequency component occurring above the fundamental frequency

****泛音****

Specialist musical/acoustic sense.

BL. OVERTONE — IMPLICATION

79. overtone

Figurative:

= additional suggestion, association, or implication

****言外之意；暗示；意味****

Practice

1. The remark had political ****overtones****.

那句話帶有政治****意味****。

2. The story has religious ****overtones****.

這個故事帶有宗教****意味****。

Very high-value figurative use.

BM. TWO-TONE

80. two-tone / two-toned

= having two distinct colours

****雙色的；兩種色調的****

Practice

1. She bought a ****two-tone**** jacket.

她買了一件****雙色外套****。

Also used for vehicles, shoes, watches, designs, etc.

BN. TONE-ON-TONE

81. tone-on-tone

Fashion/design:

= combining similar shades of the same or closely related colour

****同色系配色；同色調搭配****

Example

a ****tone-on-tone**** outfit

****同色系穿搭****

BO. TONAL — VISUAL ART / DESIGN

82. tonal

= relating to differences and relationships between light/dark values or colours

****色調的；明暗調子的****

Practice

1. The painting has strong ****tonal contrast****.

這幅畫具有強烈的****明暗對比****。

BP. TONAL RANGE

83. tonal range

Photography/art:

= range from the darkest to the lightest values in an image

****影調範圍；明暗範圍****

Practice

1. The photograph has a wide ****tonal range****.

這張照片具有很廣的****影調範圍****。

BQ. MIDTONE

84. midtone / mid-tone

= colour or brightness value between highlight and shadow

****中間調；中間亮度****

Common in photography/image editing.

BR. HALFTONE

85. halftone

Printing:

= technique/image reproducing continuous shades through patterns of dots

****網點印刷；半色調圖像****

Established printing term.

BS. CONTINUOUS TONE

86. continuous-tone image

= image containing smooth continuous gradations rather than discrete dots/levels

****連續色調圖像****

Photography/printing specialist term.

BT. TONE — VERB: ADJUST COLOUR

87. tone something

= adjust or modify its colour, often subtly

****調整色調；著色調色****

Practice

1. The image was ****toned**** to give it a warmer appearance.

圖像經過****調色****，使效果更溫暖。

2. The print was ****toned**** sepia.

照片被調成****棕褐色調****。

BU. PHOTOGRAPHIC TONING

88. toning

Photography:

= process of changing the colour or chemical character of a photographic image

****調色；色調處理****

Example

sepia ****toning****

****棕褐色調處理****

BV. HAIR TONER

89. toner — hair

= product used to adjust or neutralize unwanted tones in hair colour

****頭髮調色劑****

Practice

1. The stylist used a ****toner**** to reduce the yellow colour.

髮型師使用****調色劑****來減少黃色調。

BW. SKIN TONER

90. toner — skincare

= liquid skincare product generally applied after cleansing

****爽膚水；化妝水****

Practice

1. She applied ****toner**** after washing her face.

她洗臉後使用了****爽膚水****。

Lexicalized modern noun.

BX. PRINTER TONER

91. toner — printer

= fine powdered material used by laser printers and photocopiers

****碳粉；打印機碳粉****

Practice

1. The printer is low on ****toner****.

打印機的****碳粉****快用完了。

This is completely different from skincare ****toner**** in practical meaning.

BY. BODY / MUSCLE TONE

92. muscle tone

= natural degree of tension and firmness in muscles, even at rest

****肌張力；肌肉張力****

Practice

1. The therapist assessed the patient's ****muscle tone****.

治療師評估病人的****肌張力****。

Major medical/fitness sense.

BZ. HIGH / LOW MUSCLE TONE

93. high muscle tone

= abnormally/increased muscular tension

****肌張力偏高****

94. low muscle tone

= reduced muscular tension

****肌張力偏低****

Clinical/physiotherapy use.

CA. TONE — VERB: MAKE MUSCLES FIRMER

95. tone muscles / the body

= make muscles firmer and more defined through exercise

****鍛鍊使肌肉更結實；塑形****

Practice

1. These exercises help **tone the legs**.

這些運動有助**鍛鍊腿部肌肉，使其更結實**。

2. Swimming can help **tone the whole body**.

游泳有助**鍛鍊全身線條**。

Major fitness verb sense.

CB. TONED

96. toned

= having firm, visibly conditioned muscles

肌肉結實的；線條緊實的

Practice

1. She has strong, **toned arms**.

她有強壯而**結實的手臂肌肉**。

2. Exercise helped him become more **toned**.

運動令他的身體線條變得更**緊實**。

CC. WELL-TONED

97. well-toned

= having firm, developed muscles

肌肉線條良好的；結實的

CD. TONE UP — BODY

98. tone up

= make the body or muscles firmer through exercise

****鍛鍊得更結實；塑形****

Practice

1. She exercises to ****tone up****.

她做運動來****塑形 / 令身體更結實****。

2. These exercises ****tone up the abdominal muscles****.

這些運動能****鍛鍊腹部肌肉****。

CE. TONE DOWN — REDUCE INTENSITY

99. tone something down

= make something less strong, extreme, bright, offensive, emotional, etc.

****緩和；降低強度；收斂****

Practice

1. You should ****tone down the language****.

你應該****把措辭放緩一點****。

2. The designer ****toned down the colours****.

設計師把色彩****調得柔和一些****。

3. He was asked to ****tone down his criticism****.

有人要求他****收斂一下批評的力度****。

Extremely high-value phrasal verb.

CF. TONE DOWN — PERSONAL BEHAVIOUR

100. tone it down

= behave or speak less loudly, aggressively, dramatically, etc.

****收斂一點；別那麼強烈****

Practice

1. Could you **tone it down** a little?

你可以**收斂一點嗎**？

2. The argument was getting loud, so the teacher told everyone to **tone it down**.

爭論聲越來越大，老師叫大家**冷靜 / 收斂一點**。

CG. TONED-DOWN

101. toned-down

= made less extreme, vivid, strong, controversial, etc.

較溫和的；弱化的；低調的

Practice

1. They released a **toned-down version** of the advertisement.

他們推出了一個**較溫和版本**的廣告。

CH. TONE IN WITH

102. tone in with something

Especially BrE, less common:

= harmonize or match in colour/style

與……色調協調；相襯

Example

The curtains **tone in with** the walls.

窗簾的色調**與牆壁很協調**。

Lower priority but established.

CI. TONE INDICATOR

103. tone indicator

Internet communication:

= marker added to written text to clarify intended emotional/pragmatic meaning such as sarcasm or joking

****語氣標記；語氣提示符****

Examples include textual conventions used to clarify that something is joking, sarcastic, serious, etc.

Modern digital-language term.

CJ. KEY GRAMMAR — IN A ... TONE

104. in a + adjective + tone

Very common pattern:

- * in a quiet tone
- * in a firm tone
- * in an angry tone
- * in a friendly tone
- * in a sarcastic tone
- * in a threatening tone

****以.....的語氣****

CK. TONE OF + NOUN

105. tone of something

Common:

- * tone of voice
- * tone of the conversation
- * tone of the article
- * tone of the debate
- * tone of the meeting
- * tone of the message

Meaning varies between:

****語氣 / 口吻 / 基調 / 氣氛****

CL. SHIFT IN TONE

106. shift in tone

= noticeable change in manner, mood, attitude, or style

****語調 / 基調轉變****

Practice

1. There is a clear ****shift in tone**** halfway through the passage.

文章中段出現明顯的****語調轉變****。

High-value literary-analysis expression.

CM. TONE vs PITCH

107. tone vs pitch

****pitch****

= how high or low a sound is

****音高****

****tone****

can mean:

* attitude in the voice

* sound quality

* musical sound

Compare:

> Her pitch rose at the end of the sentence.

> 她句尾的****音高****上升。

> Her tone sounded annoyed.

> 她的****語氣****聽起來很不耐煩。

Critical distinction.

CN. TONE vs INTONATION

108. tone vs intonation

****intonation****

= pattern of pitch rising and falling across speech

****語調 ; 抑揚****

****tone****

= broader attitude or emotional manner expressed through the voice

****語氣 ; 口吻****

Compare:

> rising intonation

> 上升語調

> sarcastic tone

> 諷刺口吻

However, everyday English sometimes uses ****tone**** loosely where linguistic analysis would distinguish intonation, pitch, voice quality, etc.

CO. TONE vs TIMBRE

109. tone vs timbre

****timbre****

= characteristic sound quality distinguishing one instrument/voice from another

****音色****

****tone****

= broader everyday/music word that can also refer to sound quality

****音色 ; 音質 ; 音調****

So:

> warm violin tone

can refer to the violin's ****音色****.

CP. TONE vs VOLUME

110. tone vs volume

****volume****

= loudness

****音量****

****tone****

= manner or quality

****語氣 / 音色****

A person can speak:

* quietly but angrily

* loudly but warmly

So volume and tone are independent.

CQ. TONE vs ATTITUDE

111. tone vs attitude

****attitude****

= underlying way someone thinks or feels

****態度****

****tone****

= way that attitude is communicated through speech/writing

****語氣 / 口吻****

A hostile attitude often produces a hostile tone, but the two are not identical.

CR. TONE vs VOICE — WRITING

112. tone vs voice

In writing:

****voice****

= writer's distinctive overall personality/style

****作者聲音；個人文風****

****tone****

= attitude toward the particular subject/audience

****語調；態度****

A writer's ****voice**** may remain recognizable across works while the ****tone**** changes from humorous to serious.

CS. TONE vs STYLE

113. tone vs style

****style****

= broad way language/art is constructed

****風格****

****tone****

= emotional or attitudinal quality

****語調；基調****

Style includes much more than tone.

CT. TONE vs REGISTER

114. tone vs register

****register****

= level/type of language appropriate to a social situation

****語域；語體****

****tone****

= attitude/manner communicated

****語氣****

Compare:

> formal register

> 正式語體

> warm tone

> 溫暖語氣

CU. TONE vs MOOD

115. tone vs mood

****tone****

= attitude/manner presented by speaker/writer

****語調 / 態度****

****mood****

= emotional atmosphere or state

****氣氛 / 情緒****

Particularly important in literary study.

CV. TONE vs SHADE

116. tone vs shade — colour

****tone****

= overall quality/degree of a colour

****色調****

****shade****

= particular darker/lighter variation of a colour; everyday word for a specific variation

****色澤 ; 色度 ; 深淺****

There is substantial overlap.

CW. TONE vs HUE

117. tone vs hue

****hue****

= basic colour family/wavelength category

****色相****

****tone****

= visual quality produced by relative lightness, darkness, saturation, etc.

****色調****

Art terminology may define these more technically than everyday English.

CX. TONE vs TINT

118. tint

= lighter variation of a colour, technically often produced by adding white

****淺色；淡色調****

****tone****

= broader colour quality

****色調****

CY. UNDERTONE vs OVERTONE

119. undertone

= subtle underlying feeling, colour, or quiet sound

****底調；隱含意味；低聲****

120. overtone

= additional suggestion or acoustic upper component

****意味；暗示；泛音****

Despite their forms, these are not simple opposites in all contexts.

CZ. TONE-DEAF vs DEAF

121. tone-deaf

= difficulty distinguishing musical pitch; figuratively socially insensitive

****五音不全的；不顧情境的****

****deaf****

= unable or having limited ability to hear

****失聰 / 聽障的****

Being tone-deaf does not mean being unable to hear.

DA. TONE vs TUNE

122. tone vs tune

****tone****

= individual sound / sound quality / voice manner

****音；音色；語氣****

****tune****

= sequence of musical notes forming a melody

****曲調；旋律****

Compare:

> a pure tone

> 一個純音

> a catchy tune

> 一首容易記住的旋律

DB. TONED vs TONE

123. toned — fitness

= firm and defined

****結實有線條的****

124. toned — colour compound

Can also appear in compounds:

> warm-toned skin

> ****暖色調膚色****

> blue-toned grey

> ****帶藍調的灰色****

So ****toned**** is not exclusively a fitness word.

DC. TONAL — THREE MAJOR DOMAINS

125. tonal — music

= relating to tones/keys

****調性的****

126. tonal — language

= relating to lexical tone

****聲調的****

> tonal language

> 聲調語言

127. tonal — visual art

= relating to relationships among light/dark or colour values

****色調 / 明暗調子的****

One adjective, three important domain branches.

DD. TONALITY — BROADER USE

128. tonality — music

****調性****

129. tonality — visual/artistic

Less common:

= overall tonal/color character

****整體色調 / 明暗關係****

The music sense is much more central.

DE. TONER — THREE MAJOR MODERN MEANINGS

130. printer toner

打印機碳粉

131. skin toner

爽膚水 / 化妝水

132. hair toner

頭髮調色劑

These are easy MCQ traps because the same form has completely different concrete referents.

DF. FAMILY SWEEP

133. tone — voice/attitude

語氣；口吻

134. tone — text/literature

語調；作者態度

135. tone — general atmosphere

基調；格調

136. tone — musical sound

樂音；音調

137. tone — sound quality

音色

138. tone — musical interval

全音

139. tone — linguistic pitch category

聲調

140. tone — electronic signal

****提示音 / 訊號音****

141. tone — colour

****色調****

142. tone — muscle tension

****肌張力****

143. tone — verb, exercise

****使肌肉更結實****

144. tone — verb, colour/image

****調整色調****

DG. SEMANTIC MAP

The historical/core idea behind many uses of ****tone**** is:

****a distinctive quality produced by sound****

From there, modern English develops several large branches.

A. Voice

> angry tone

> → ****憤怒語氣****

The sound of the voice conveys attitude.

B. Written attitude

> tone of an email

> → ****電郵口吻****

The idea moves from audible manner to the attitude communicated by language.

C. Overall atmosphere

> set the tone

> → **定下基調**

The attitude of communication becomes the overall character of an event.

D. Music

> musical tone

> → **樂音**

> warm tone

> → **溫暖音色**

> whole tone

> → **全音**

E. Language

> Mandarin tone

> → **聲調**

Pitch differences become part of lexical meaning.

F. Electronic signals

> dial tone

> → **撥號音**

> warning tone

> → **警告音**

G. Colour

> warm tones
> → **暖色調**

The idea of a characteristic “quality” transfers from sound to visual appearance.

H. Body

> muscle tone
> → **肌張力**

> tone your arms
> → **鍛鍊手臂使其更結實**

I. Reduction / moderation

> tone down criticism
> → **緩和批評**

> tone down colours
> → **降低色彩強度**

The underlying idea is making something less strong in “tone.”

DH. MASTER COMPARISON — MCQ-READY

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
tone — passage / voice	說話時透過聲音表達出的情緒、態度或意圖；語氣 / 口吻
tone of voice	說話聲音所呈現的態度或情緒
in a ... tone	以某種語氣說話
take/use a tone	採用某種口吻或態度
watch your tone	注意自己的說話口氣；別太無禮
mind your tone	注意你的語氣 / 口吻
take that tone with someone	用令人不滿 / 無禮的口氣跟某人說話
change one's tone — voice	改變說話語氣
change one's tone — attitude	改變態度 / 口風
tone — written language	文字中所傳達的態度 / 口吻
tone of an email/message	電郵 / 訊息所使用的語氣

formal tone	正式、專業的語氣 / 文風	
informal tone	輕鬆、口語化的語氣	
sarcastic tone	帶有諷刺意味的語氣	
literary tone	作者 / 敘述者對題材或讀者所呈現的態度	
tone of a text	文章整體呈現的語調 / 態度	
tone — general character	活動、討論、關係等的整體基調 / 氣氛	
set the tone	為接下來的事情定下氣氛、風格或態度	
strike a ... tone	有意採取某種口吻 / 基調	
strike the right tone	選用恰當的語氣 / 態度	
lower the tone	尤其英式：使談話 / 活動的格調降低	
tone at the top	高層領導所建立的道德、合規及組織文化基調	
tone policing	把焦點放在說話者的情緒 / 語氣，而忽略其實質訴求	
tone — musical sound	具有特定音高的樂音 / 聲音	
high/low tone	高 / 低音調	
pure tone	主要由單一頻率組成的純音	
test tone	用來測試音響、聽力等的標準測試音	
tone — timbre	樂器或聲音獨特的音色 / 音質	
tone quality	聲音本身的音色 / 音質	
tone colour/color	音色	
tone — musical interval	英式音樂術語：兩個半音構成的一個全音	
whole-tone scale	全部由全音構成的全音音階	
tonal — music	與音調 / 調性有關的	
tonality	音樂圍繞中心調 / 主音建立的調性	
tonal center	樂曲的調性中心	
twelve-tone music	使用十二音技法創作的音樂	
tone row	十二音音樂中的音列	
tone poem	以音樂描繪故事 / 意象的交響詩	
tone-deaf — literal	難以辨別 / 唱準音高的；俗稱五音不全	
tone-deaf — figurative	對他人感受、社會氣氛或情境極不敏感的	
toneless	聲音缺乏情緒、抑揚或表情的	
monotone	音高 / 語調幾乎沒有變化的單調聲音	
tone — linguistics	在聲調語言中可改變詞義的音高模式；聲調	
tone language / tonal language	用聲調區分詞義的語言	
tone mark	標示聲調的符號	
tone number	用數字標示聲調的系統	
tone contour	聲調內部音高升降的輪廓	
tone sandhi	因相鄰聲調 / 語境而發生的變調	
tone — electronic signal	用作提示或訊號的電子聲音	
dial tone	電話可開始撥號時的撥號音	
busy/engaged tone	電話線忙時發出的忙音	
ringtone	手機有來電時播放的鈴聲	
warning tone	用來提醒危險 / 故障的警告音	
notification tone	電子裝置有通知時發出的提示音	
touch-tone	按鍵產生音頻訊號的電話系統	
tone control	調整音響高低頻 / 音色的控制	
instrument/guitar tone	樂器產生的整體音色與聲音質感	

tonearm	黑膠唱盤承載唱針的唱臂	
tone — colour	某種顏色的深淺、冷暖或整體色調	
warm tone	偏紅、黃、橙等感覺的暖色調	
cool tone	偏藍、綠等感覺的冷色調	
muted tone	柔和、低飽和度的色調	
skin tone	人的天然膚色	
undertone — colour	表面顏色之下較細微的底色 / 底調	
undertone — feeling	沒有明說但隱約存在的情緒 / 意味	
in an undertone	以很低的聲音說話	
overtone — acoustics	基頻以上的泛音	
overtone — figurative	附帶的暗示、聯想或言外之意	
two-tone	具有兩種明顯顏色 / 色調的	
tone-on-tone	使用同一 / 相近色系不同深淺的配色	
tonal — visual	與畫面明暗 / 色調關係有關的	
tonal range	圖像從最暗到最亮的影調範圍	
midtone	介乎高光與陰影之間的中間調	
halftone	以網點模擬連續深淺的半色調印刷 / 圖像	
continuous tone	具有連續明暗漸變的圖像	
tone — verb colour	調整圖像 / 材料的色調	
photographic toning	改變照片色調的處理	
hair toner	用來調整 / 中和髮色色調的調色劑	
skin toner	潔面後使用的爽膚水 / 化妝水	
printer toner	雷射打印機 / 影印機使用的碳粉	
muscle tone	肌肉即使休息時仍保持的自然張力；肌張力	
high/low muscle tone	肌張力偏高 / 偏低	
tone muscles/body	透過鍛鍊使肌肉 / 身體線條更結實	
toned	肌肉緊實、有明顯線條的	
well-toned	肌肉鍛鍊良好、線條結實的	
tone up	透過運動令身體 / 肌肉更結實	
tone down something	令言辭、色彩、批評、行為等變得較溫和 / 不強烈	
tone it down	收斂一點；把聲量 / 態度 / 強度降低	
toned-down	經過弱化、變得較溫和 / 低調的	
tone in with	英式：在色調或風格上與某物協調	
tone indicator	網上文字中用來提示玩笑、諷刺等意圖的語氣標記	
shift in tone	語氣、態度或作品基調的明顯轉變	
toner — printer	打印機 / 影印機碳粉	
toner — skincare	爽膚水 / 化妝水	
toner — hair	調整髮色色調的產品	

DI. PASSAGE RECAP

> “...students who seldom spoke in class could identify the conflict, describe the characters’ motives and explain how **tone**, gesture and hesitation changed the meaning of a sentence.”

Here:

****tone****

= ****the way a person's voice expresses attitude, emotion, or intention****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****語氣****

* ****口吻****

* contextually: ****說話時的語氣****

Natural contextual translation:

****到了我們寫反思文章時，即使平日很少在課堂上發言的學生，也能指出其中的衝突、描述人物的動機，並解釋語氣、手勢和猶豫如何改變一句話的意思。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****tone****

= ****the emotional or attitudinal quality of someone's voice when speaking****

****語氣；口吻****

The crucial point is that ****tone is not simply pitch or volume****.

For example, the words:

> "Fine."

could communicate:

* sincere agreement,

* irritation,

* resignation,

* sarcasm,

* fear,

depending on the speaker's ****tone****.

The biggest learner branches are:

> ****tone of voice****

> → ****語氣****

> ****tone of an email****

> → ****文字口吻****

> ****set the tone****

> → ****定下基調****

> ****literary tone****

> → ****作者 / 敘述者的態度****

> ****musical tone****

> → ****樂音 / 音調****

> ****warm violin tone****

> → ****溫暖的音色****

> ****Mandarin tone****

> → ****聲調****

> ****dial tone****

> → ****撥號音****

> ****skin tone****

> → ****膚色****

> ****warm colour tones****

> → ****暖色調****

> ****muscle tone****

> → ****肌張力****

> ****toned muscles****

> → ****結實有線條的肌肉****

> ****tone down your criticism****

> → ****把批評的力度放緩****

> ****tone-deaf remark****

> → ****不顧情境 / 他人感受的言論****

> ****printer toner****

> → ****打印機碳粉****

> ****skin toner****

> → ****爽膚水****

> ****hair toner****

> → ****頭髮調色劑****

So **tone** is unusually broad, but its major modern branches can be organized quite cleanly:

voice/attitude → writing/atmosphere → musical sound → linguistic pitch → electronic signal → colour → bodily firmness.

In the passage, only the first branch applies: drama teaches students that **meaning comes not just from the words spoken, but also from how those words are delivered**.